

● SESSION 3 · COMPANION E-BOOK

AUTOMATION SYSTEMS.

*Build Systems That Work While You
Sleep — where you stop guessing about
AI and start operating it.*

ONE LIVE SESSION

Schedules, Routines, Data & external automation.

FOR EVERYONE

Written for total beginners and working professionals at once.

YOU LEAVE WITH

A live automation stack — Schedule + Routine + Zap, running.

WELCOME TO SESSION 3

WEEKLY OBJECTIVE

You built a Claude workspace that remembers and acts. Now you make it run without you — Schedules that fire on a clock, Routines you trigger in one line, data you interrogate for real decisions, and external automations that connect Claude to the apps you already use.

Identity shift — Working with AI → Systems Working for You

THE TWO HALVES OF SESSION 3

FIRST HALF

AUTOMATE ON A CLOCK & ON DEMAND

Schedules that run themselves at a set time, and Routines you fire in one line — the two ways to stop doing the same task by hand.

SECOND HALF

INTERROGATE DATA & CONNECT THE OUTSIDE

Turn a spreadsheet into decisions with analytical prompting, then wire Claude into your other apps with Zapier or n8n — and know when to leave Claude.

HOW EVERY TOPIC IS BUILT

This is your Session 3 companion — read it alongside the live class. It is written for two people at once: the total beginner who now has a Claude workspace, and the professional ready to automate. Skim the plain-English parts; stop on the prompts and the build steps.

WHAT	A plain-English definition of the idea.
WHY	Why it matters to you as an operator.
WHERE	Where you actually meet it in Claude.
WHEN	When to reach for it — and when to ignore it.
HOW	How it works under the hood, still in plain words.

Every topic also carries: advantages and disadvantages, a real example, three professional prompts at three levels, step-by-step build-up and execution, and the odd Fun Fact.

WHAT'S IN THIS SESSION

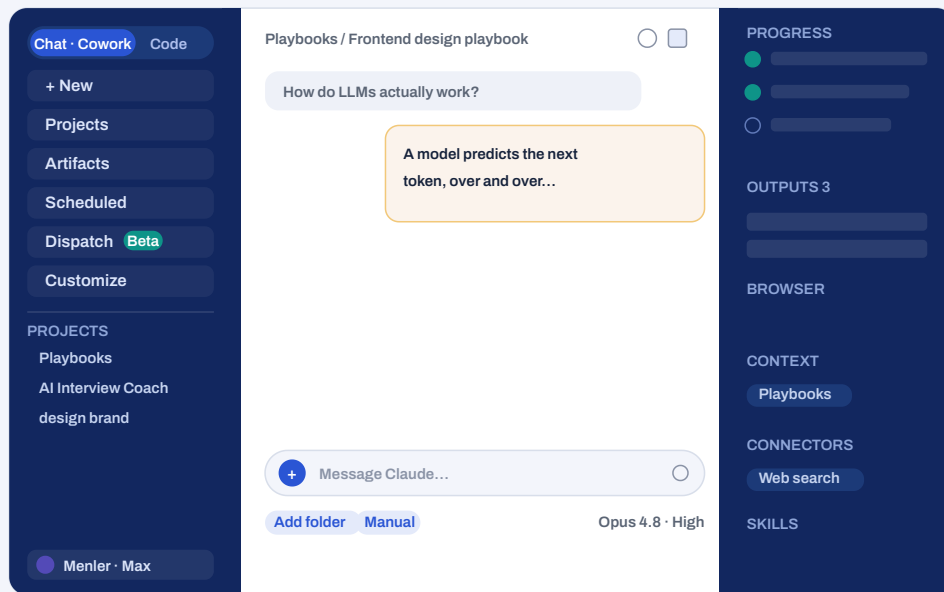
A full tour of the Claude app (3 pages), then the four topics of Session 3, then your session deliverable. Jump to whatever you need.

◆	Getting around Claude The whole interface + how to connect & automate	p. 4
3.1	Claude Schedules Time-triggered prompts that run on their own — your morning brief, waiting for you.	p. 7
3.2	Claude Routines On-demand, repeatable workflows — one line in, the same clean output every time.	p. 10
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BEFORE YOU START · THE CLAUDE-FIRST TOUR

GETTING AROUND CLAUDE

This whole program runs on Claude. Learn the app once — here is the entire window, every part labelled.



THE CLAUDE APP — LEFT SIDEBAR, TOP BAR, CHAT (CENTRE), MESSAGE BOX (BOTTOM), AND THE LIVE PANEL (RIGHT)

THE LEFT SIDEBAR — WHERE YOU MOVE BETWEEN KINDS OF WORK

New — Start a fresh chat or Cowork session. Nothing carries over unless the session shares a Project.

Artifacts — Your gallery of built pages and docs (dashboards, mini-apps, reports) that live on beyond the chat and can be re-opened or shared.

Dispatch — Hand a job to a background agent that plans and runs it while you do other things. (Beta.)

Projects list — Your projects pinned for quick access; click one to jump straight into its space.

Projects — Your Projects — shared folders of chats, files and instructions that persist across sessions and your team.

Scheduled — Tasks that run on a schedule — hourly, daily, weekly. View, pause, edit or run them here.

Customize — Your home for connectors, custom instructions, styles and preferences — set once, applies everywhere.

Account · plan — Bottom-left: who you are and your plan (e.g. Max). The download icon gets the desktop app.

THE TOP BAR — WHERE YOU ARE, AND HOW TO GET AROUND

Chat · Cowork / Code — The mode switch. “Chat & Cowork” for everyday work with files and tools; “Code” opens Claude Code, the developer surface.

Back / forward — Move through screens you have visited, like a browser.

Panel & theme — Top-right icons: show or hide the side panels and switch light / dark.

Search — Find any past chat, project or output by keyword.

Breadcrumb — Shows where you are (e.g. Playbooks / Frontend design...). Click a crumb to go up a level.

THE MESSAGE BOX — HOW YOU BRIEF CLAUDE AND CONTROL IT

The “+” — Add connectors, upload files, and switch on skills for this message.

Approval: Manual / Auto / Skip — When Claude asks before acting. Manual = approve every action; Auto = auto-approves reads, checks writes; Skip = no prompts (trusted work only).

Model · reasoning — Pick the model (e.g. Opus 4.8) and the thinking effort — High for hard problems, lower for speed.

Add folder — Give the session a folder from your computer to read and write — pick the smallest folder that holds what is needed.

Dictate — The mic — talk instead of type.

THE PANEL ON THE RIGHT — WHAT CLAUDE SHOWS YOU WHILE IT WORKS

Progress — The live task list — every step Claude is taking, ticking off as it goes.

Browser · Claude in Chrome — The browser Claude is driving for web tasks, when a browser is connected.

Connectors — The apps switched on for this session (e.g. Web search); add more from “+” or Customize.

Outputs — The finished files from this session — open, preview, download, or send some to Drive.

Context — What this session can see — the connected Project and folders (e.g. Playbooks).

Skills — The packaged know-how Claude can apply here on demand.

◆ FIND IT IN CLAUDE**Message box → Manual / Auto / Skip**

Set the approval mode before a big task. New to Cowork? Start on **Manual** so you approve each action. As you trust a routine, move to **Auto**. Keep **Skip** for small, contained jobs only.

THE THREE THINGS THAT TURN CLAUDE FROM A CHATBOT INTO A WORKSPACE

Anyone can type into Claude. The step up is **connecting your own apps**, **putting work on repeat**, and **handing off jobs to the background**. Here is where each lives and how to switch it on.

1

CONNECT YOUR APPS

CONNECTORS

A connector plugs one of your apps — Gmail, Google Drive, Notion, Slack, and hundreds more — straight into Claude, so it can read and act on that data instead of you copy-pasting.

- 1 Open Settings → Connectors (or, in a chat, click “+” → Connectors → Manage connectors).
- 2 Click the “+” next to Connectors to open the directory, then pick the app you want.
- 3 Click Connect, then sign in and approve access in the pop-up (this is OAuth — you approve, Claude never sees your password).
- 4 Back in any chat, click “+” → Connectors and toggle the app on for that conversation.

Free, Pro, Max, Team & Enterprise. Team/Enterprise: an Owner enables a connector for the org first. Choose the least access that does the job.

2

PUT WORK ON REPEAT

SCHEDULED TASKS

A scheduled task is a prompt Claude runs on its own on a set cadence — a Monday digest, a daily inbox triage — and reports back with no nudge from you.

- 1 In the left sidebar, click Scheduled.
- 2 Click New task → Create with Claude (guided) or Set up manually.
- 3 Write the prompt as a full standalone instruction, pick the cadence (hourly / daily / weekly / weekdays), and set the approval mode + folder.
- 4 Click Schedule. Pause, edit, or run it on demand any time from the same page.

Pro, Max, Team & Enterprise. Desktop for all paid plans; web & mobile in beta.

3

HAND OFF, WALK AWAY

DISPATCH

Dispatch is a background agent. You describe an outcome once; it breaks the job into tasks, runs each on its own, and surfaces the results later — even from your phone.

- 1 In the left sidebar, select Dispatch.
- 2 Describe the outcome like you would brief a colleague, in one message.
- 3 Let it plan — it starts child tasks that each show a status (Running, Awaiting input, Completed...).
- 4 Check back later: open any task to read the transcript and grab the files it produced.

Pro & Max, on the latest Claude Desktop (macOS/Windows). Keep the desktop app open to assign from mobile.

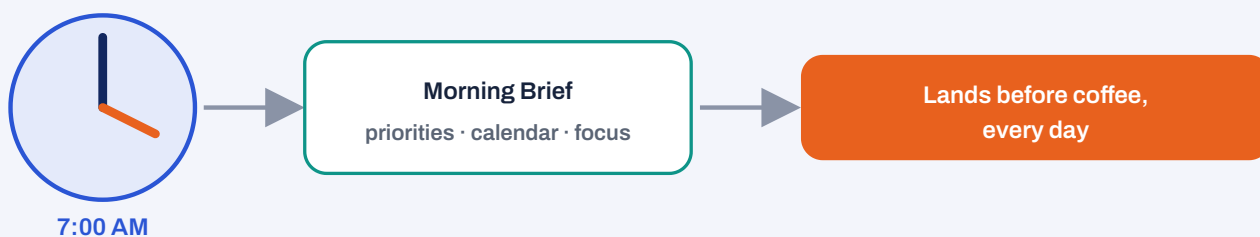
3.1

SESSION 3

CLAUDE SCHEDULES

Time-triggered prompts that run on their own — your morning brief, waiting for you.

Trigger time → self-contained prompt → output that lands

**WHAT**

A **Schedule** is a prompt that Claude runs automatically at a time you set — every morning at 7, every Monday, the first of the month. Its anatomy is three parts: a **trigger time**, a **self-contained prompt**, and an **output** that lands where you will see it.

WHY

It turns a task you keep forgetting — or keep doing by hand — into something that just happens. A morning brief, a weekly review, a month-end summary: done before you sit down, every single time, with zero effort from you after setup.

WHERE

In the left sidebar under **Scheduled** → **New task**. You write the prompt once, pick how often it runs, and Claude reports the result back each time it fires.

WHEN

Schedule anything that repeats on a *clock* — a daily digest, a Friday round-up, a recurring reminder with a bit of thinking attached. If a job only runs when you decide, that is a Routine (next topic), not a Schedule.

HOW IT WORKS

Claude stores your prompt and runs it unattended at each trigger. Because you are not there to add context, the prompt must be **self-contained** — it has to carry everything Claude needs. To pull in *live* data (today's calendar, today's inbox) the Schedule needs a **Connector** feeding it; without one it reasons from what the prompt already contains.

ADVANTAGES

- + Runs itself — set once, benefit daily
- + Forces a self-contained prompt, which makes it reliable
- + Great for briefs, digests and recurring reviews

DISADVANTAGES

- Cannot see live data without a Connector attached
- A vague prompt produces a vague brief every day
- Runs whether or not you still need it — prune it

EXAMPLE

A **Morning Brief** at 7am: "Summarise my day — my top 3 priorities from my goals doc, one motivating line, and one thing I am likely avoiding." With Google Calendar connected it adds today's meetings. It lands before coffee, every day.

**Fun Fact**

The first Schedule most operators build is a morning brief — and it is usually the one habit that outlives the novelty of AI, because it quietly saves ten minutes at the exact moment of day when ten minutes is worth the most.

◆ FIND IT IN CLAUDE

Sidebar → Scheduled → New task

Build your first Schedule. Open **Scheduled**, click New task, paste a self-contained Morning Brief prompt, pick the time and cadence, and Schedule it. It runs on its own and reports back each morning.

THREE PROFESSIONAL PROMPTS, THREE LEVELS

LEVEL 1 · BEGINNER

FILL THE ORANGE

Help me write a Morning Brief I can schedule in Claude. Ask me 3 questions about what I want to know each morning, then write one self-contained prompt I can paste into a scheduled task.

LEVEL 2 · INTERMEDIATE

FILL THE ORANGE

Act as an operator coach. Design a scheduled Morning Brief for a role: what to include, the exact output format (headings + bullets), and a line telling me the one thing to do first. Make the prompt self-contained so it works with no extra context.

LEVEL 3 · PROFESSIONAL

FILL THE ORANGE

Act as my automation architect. Draft a weekly-review Schedule prompt for my work: pull my stated priorities, structure the output as Wins / Slipping / Decide-this-week, and end with 3 questions I should answer. Note exactly which Connector it needs to add live data, and what it can do without one.

BUILD IT UP — STEP BY STEP

- 1 Open **Scheduled** in the left sidebar and click **New task**.
- 2 Write a **self-contained** prompt — everything Claude needs, since you will not be there.
- 3 Pick the trigger time and how often (daily, weekdays, weekly).
- 4 Choose where the output should go, and Schedule it.

EXECUTE IT

- 1 Score Day 1's output out of 10, then edit one line of the prompt.
- 2 Run it 3 mornings; watch the brief get sharper as you tune it.
- 3 Attach a **Connector** (Calendar, Gmail) if it needs today's live data.
- 4 Share Day 1 vs Day 3 side by side in Discord — show the prompt evolution.

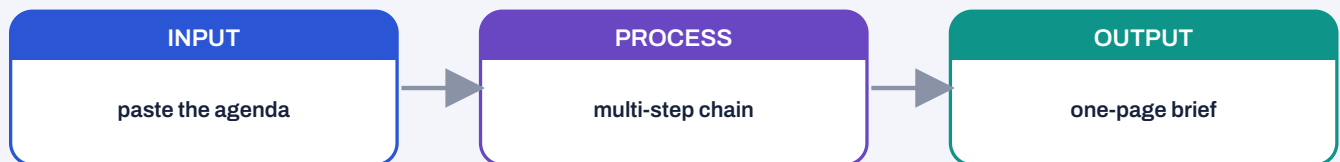
3.2

SESSION 3

CLAUDE ROUTINES

On-demand, repeatable workflows — one line in, the same clean output every time.

Input template → prompt chain → fixed output, on demand



Trigger in one line — same quality every time

WHAT

A **Routine** is a saved multi-step workflow you trigger on demand, not on a clock. Its anatomy is three parts: an **input template** (what you paste in), a **prompt chain** (how Claude processes it), and a fixed **output format**. Trigger it with one line whenever you need it.

WHY

Any task you do more than twice a week that follows a pattern is wasting your time by hand. A Routine turns “prep, process, produce” into a single reusable button, so the tenth time is as fast and consistent as you wish the first had been.

WHERE

Build it inside a **Claude Project** so it inherits your context and files, and save the prompt as a Skill or saved instruction. Then trigger it in any chat in that Project with one line.

WHEN

Reach for a Routine when the *trigger is you* — a meeting to prep, a post to repurpose, a decision to weigh. If the trigger is a time, use a Schedule instead. If it happens once, just prompt normally.

HOW IT WORKS

You define the shape of the input (“here is the agenda”) and the shape of the output (“give me a one-page brief”), and the steps in between. Because it lives in a Project, it already knows your role and your style, so the same input reliably yields the same quality of output.

ADVANTAGES

- + Consistent output for tasks you repeat
- + One-line trigger — no re-explaining the steps
- + Lives in a Project, so it inherits your context

DISADVANTAGES

- Only worth building for genuinely recurring tasks
- A weak input template gives Claude too little to work with
- Needs a test-and-refine pass before you trust it

EXAMPLE

A **Meeting Prep** Routine: paste an agenda, and Claude returns a one-page brief — attendees and their likely goals, three questions to ask, your one desired outcome, and risks to watch. Same structure every meeting, in seconds.

**Fun Fact**

The difference between a prompt and a Routine is the difference between cooking a dish once and writing the recipe. Operators who move fastest are quietly building a cookbook — a library of Routines their whole week runs on.

◆ FIND IT IN CLAUDE

Sidebar → Projects → saved instructions

Save a Routine inside a Project. Build the Routine in a **Project** so it inherits your context, then save its prompt as a saved instruction or Skill. From then on it is one line to trigger — see p.4–6 for where these live.

THREE PROFESSIONAL PROMPTS, THREE LEVELS

LEVEL 1 · BEGINNER

FILL THE ORANGE

I do a recurring task most weeks. Help me turn it into a reusable Routine: tell me what to paste in, then write the prompt Claude should run on it, and the exact output format.

LEVEL 2 · INTERMEDIATE

FILL THE ORANGE

Act as a workflow designer. Build a Content Repurpose Routine: input = one long-form piece; output = a LinkedIn post, an X thread, a newsletter blurb, 3 hooks and a carousel outline — each in my voice. Give me the input template and the prompt.

LEVEL 3 · PROFESSIONAL

FILL THE ORANGE

Act as my Claude architect. Design a Decision Analysis Routine for my domain: input template for the situation, a prompt chain that lays out options, weighs pros/cons against my stated priorities, and ends with one clear recommendation + confidence. Make it live inside my Project so it inherits context.

BUILD IT UP — STEP BY STEP

- 1 Pick a task you do more than twice a week that follows a pattern.
- 2 Write the **input template** — exactly what you will paste in each time.
- 3 Write the **prompt chain** and lock the **output format**.
- 4 Save it inside your Claude **Project** so it is one line to trigger.

EXECUTE IT

- 1 Run it with 2 real inputs and check the output is equally good both times.
- 2 Refine the prompt after the first run; note what you changed.
- 3 Keep the output format strict — that is what makes it reliable.
- 4 Share the Routine prompt + one sample output in Discord.

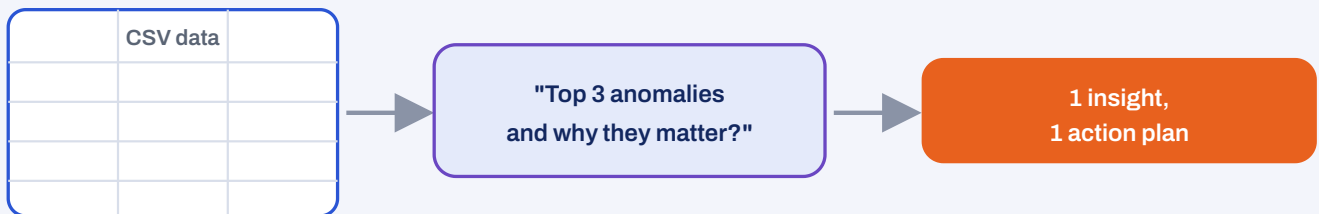
3.3

SESSION 3

CLAUDE FOR DATA

Upload a spreadsheet, ask five sharp questions, walk away with one real decision.

Upload a table → ask a sharp question → get a decision



WHAT

Claude can read a **CSV or table** you upload — spot patterns, extract themes, find anomalies, and summarise. It *reads and reasons* over your data; it does not run live formulas. The skill is **analytical prompting**: asking a specific question, not “summarise this”.

WHY

Most people have data they never question — expenses, results, a project tracker — because opening the spreadsheet feels like work. Claude turns that pile into answers in minutes, and often surfaces the one thing you would never have noticed by scrolling.

WHERE

Click the “+” in the message box → **Upload**, drop in your file, then ask. For a set you reuse, keep it in a **Project** so every question shares the same data.

WHEN

Use Claude for data when you want *insight and a decision* — patterns, outliers, what to do next. When you need live formulas, pivot tables, or exact recalculation on changing numbers, go to Excel or Sheets AI instead.

HOW IT WORKS

You frame the question as: what you have, what you want to know, and what decision it serves. Specificity drives insight — “find the top 3 anomalies and why they matter” beats “summarise this”. Claude reasons over the numbers and explains; it does not compute a live sheet.

ADVANTAGES

- + Turns a raw file into decisions in minutes
- + Finds patterns and anomalies you would miss
- + No formulas to write — you just ask in words

DISADVANTAGES

- Reads and reasons; it does not run live calculations
- Vague questions get shallow summaries
- Always sanity-check a number before you act on it

EXAMPLE

Upload three months of **expenses**. Ask: “Which category grew fastest, name the 3 biggest one-off spikes, and where could I cut 10% with least pain?” The answer is a savings plan — not a summary — in under a minute.

**Fun Fact**

Claude cannot recalculate a live spreadsheet — but that limit is a feature. Because it reasons instead of computing, it answers the question a formula never can: not “what is the total?” but “what should I do about it?”

THREE PROFESSIONAL PROMPTS, THREE LEVELS

LEVEL 1 · BEGINNER

FILL THE ORANGE

I am uploading a spreadsheet of what it is. Ask me what decision I am trying to make, then give me the 5 most useful specific questions I should ask you about this data.

LEVEL 2 · INTERMEDIATE

FILL THE ORANGE

Analyse this dataset. Find the top 3 anomalies or surprises, explain why each matters for my goal, and flag anything that looks like a data-quality problem rather than a real signal.

LEVEL 3 · PROFESSIONAL

FILL THE ORANGE

Act as a data analyst for my role. From this dataset: (1) the 3 findings that change a decision, (2) the one insight I would miss by eye, (3) a 1-paragraph action plan, (4) what you cannot tell from this data and what I would need to answer it.

BUILD IT UP — STEP BY STEP

- 1 Find a real dataset — your expenses, results, a tracker, or a public set from Kaggle / data.gov.in.
- 2 Upload it and ask **5 specific** analytical questions, not “summarise this”.
- 3 Pick the 1 insight you would not have noticed without AI.
- 4 Turn it into a 1-paragraph action plan: what you will do differently.

EXECUTE IT

- 1 Frame each question as: what I have, what I want to know, what decision it serves.
- 2 Ask Claude to separate real signal from likely data errors.
- 3 Build a **Data Insight Brief** Artifact: dataset, 5 Q&A, 1 insight, 1 action.
- 4 Add it to your portfolio and share the link in Discord.

3.4

SESSION 3

EXTERNAL AUTOMATION

Zapier, n8n and the Claude-first rule — connect the outside world, only when you must.

Trigger → Claude step → Output — the automation spine



Claude-first: go external only when native cannot

WHAT

External automation tools like **Zapier** and **n8n** connect your apps so an event in one triggers an action in another — with a **Claude step** in the middle to think. The anatomy is simple: **Trigger** → **Claude step** → **Output** to wherever you need it.

WHY

Some jobs live across apps Claude cannot reach on its own — a form submission that should become a Notion row, an email from a key contact that should become a drafted reply. External automation is how Claude acts *outside* its own window.

WHERE

You build the flow in Zapier (hosted, easiest) or n8n (open-source, self-host) and drop the **Claude action** into the middle as the reasoning step. Design the logic first; pick the tool second.

WHEN

The **Claude-first rule**: exhaust native tools — Schedules, Routines, Connectors — before going external. Reach for Zapier/n8n only when you genuinely need multi-app triggers, live feeds, or output landing in another platform.

HOW IT WORKS

You draw the flow on paper first — trigger, the exact Claude prompt, output destination — then build it. n8n is open-source and cheaper to run at volume but has a higher complexity ceiling; Zapier is hosted and faster to start. Test with real inputs and debug the step that breaks.

ADVANTAGES

- + Connects Claude to apps it cannot reach alone
- + Runs fully hands-off once live
- + Design-on-paper first keeps it simple and debuggable

DISADVANTAGES

- Adds a tool and a bill — use only when native falls short
- More moving parts means more that can break
- n8n's power comes with a steeper learning curve

EXAMPLE

A **Google Form** submission → a **Claude step** that summarises the response and drafts a reply → a new **Notion** row plus a Gmail draft. A lead capture that used to be twenty minutes of copy-paste now happens the moment someone hits submit.



Fun Fact

The best operators reach for Zapier last, not first. Every external tool is another thing to maintain — so the Claude-first rule is really a cost rule: keep it native until native genuinely cannot do the job.

◆ FIND IT IN CLAUDE

Zapier → add step → Claude

Add the Claude action in Zapier. In your Zap, add a step and pick the **Claude action** for the reasoning in the middle. Prefer a native **Connector** (Customize → Connectors) whenever it can do the job without leaving Claude.

THREE PROFESSIONAL PROMPTS, THREE LEVELS

LEVEL 1 · BEGINNER

FILL THE ORANGE

I want to automate this: when trigger happens, Claude should do this, and the result should go to destination. Write the plan as Trigger → Claude step → Output, and the exact Claude prompt for the middle step.

LEVEL 2 · INTERMEDIATE

FILL THE ORANGE

Act as an automation designer. I get inputs into app. Map a Zapier flow that runs a Claude step to process them and sends the result to app. List the trigger, the Claude prompt, the output action, and the 2 things most likely to break.

LEVEL 3 · PROFESSIONAL

FILL THE ORANGE

Act as my systems architect. Design a weekly intelligence loop: a Claude Schedule generates a brief, that output triggers a Zap that distributes it. Give me the flowchart, each step, the Claude prompts, and where a Connector beats an external tool.

BUILD IT UP — STEP BY STEP

- 1 Design it on paper first: **Trigger** → **Claude step** → **Output** destination.
- 2 Build it in Zapier (free tier) or n8n, dropping in the **Claude action**.
- 3 Write the exact prompt for the Claude step — self-contained, like a Schedule.
- 4 Trigger it 3 times with real inputs and screenshot each output.

EXECUTE IT

- 1 Check the output arrived where you needed it, and that Claude's step was accurate.
- 2 Debug the one step that breaks — usually the trigger or a field mapping.
- 3 Document it: name · problem solved · time saved · what to improve.
- 4 Ship the Session 3 deliverable: Schedule + Routine + Zap in one Artifact.



YOUR SESSION 3 DELIVERABLE

LIVE AUTOMATION SYSTEM

The one thing to build this session — it feeds straight into Session 4.

IMAGE PLACEHOLDER — GENERATE & DROP IN

A hero image for your automation stack cover

STRUCTURED PROMPT FOR CHATGPT / GEMINI / FIREFLY

SUBJECT	three glowing pipelines running in parallel, left to right
ENVIRONMENT	deep-navy control-room backdrop, soft vignette, space along the top for a title
REFERENCE	clean flat-vector infographic, modern tech-brand illustration
MOTION STYLE	still (for a video cover: slow left-to-right flow along the three pipelines)

OBJECT	a clock, a one-line trigger and an app icon feeding three lanes into a labelled “Claude” core
SITUATION	the three systems quietly running on their own, lines pulsing with flow
COLOUR STYLE	deep navy base, warm orange accents, small teal & purple highlights, high contrast
GEOMETRY STYLE	three horizontal lanes converging on a central node, generous negative space at top, 3:2

BRIEF	Ship three automations that run together and save real time: a Schedule (time-triggered — run 3 days, keep Day 1 vs Day 3), a Routine (on-demand — input template + prompt chain + fixed output), and an external Zap (Trigger → Claude step → Output). Each solves a different real problem.
SUBMIT AS	One Claude Artifact — an Automation Stack Map: all three systems, the problem each solves, and time saved. Portfolio asset #3.
TIME	90 minutes
TOOLS	Claude Schedules · Routines · Projects · Zapier / n8n · Google Workspace
FEEDS INTO	Feeds into Session 4 — these systems become part of the capstone you build, demo and put on your portfolio.

◆ FIND IT IN CLAUDE

Message box → Artifact appears beside the chat

Publish the stack as an Artifact. Ask Claude to build your **Automation Stack Map** as an Artifact — it saves beside the chat and drops straight into your portfolio.

SESSION 3 OUTCOME

THE SYSTEMS ARE LIVE.

*A Schedule that briefs you on a clock,
Routines you trigger in one line, data
you interrogate for real decisions, and
an external automation that connects
Claude to the apps you already use.*

*You are not doing the work anymore.
Your systems are.*

Working with AI → Systems Working for You

NEXT · SESSION 4

Your automations are running. Session 4 is the **build sprint** — vibe-code a real tool with no code, ship your capstone, demo it live, and turn everything you built into a portfolio that proves you are AI-native.

menler

Your turning point in the AI era.